

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
We take the newest
upscaling tech from
AMD out for a spin, then
in Startup Corner, we
explore some Indian
Neobanks, in Level Up, we
provide some nifty tips
and tricks to supercharge
your messaging apps.



Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 1 Plus SoC launch could take place in May

Qualcomm may launch the Snapdragon 8 Gen 1+ in May which is a bit earlier than usual. The new 8 Gen 1 Plus edition would also reportedly switch to a TSMC 4nm process. The report comes from tipster Yogesh Brar (via Onsitego). <https://dgit.in/sd8gen-1plus>

WHAT'S NEW

Google is working towards eSIM-only phones with Android 13

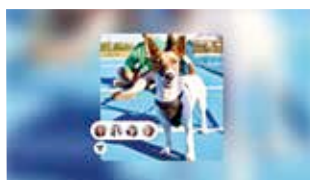
Google released the Android 13 Developer Preview 2 a while ago, but even now, new features of Android 13 are being spotted. One such feature (found by Mishaal Rahman of Esper.io) is the support for Multiple Enabled Profiles (MEP) which lets a single eSIM simultaneously connect to two different carrier connections. This would open up possibilities for eSIM-only or even portless phones. With Multiple Enabled Profiles (MEP), a single physical interface is involved between a SIM profile and a modem but with multiple logical (software) interfaces. All of these separate logical interfaces will have their



own independent communication channel between the said SIM profile and modem. The modem will identify the logical interfaces like physical ones only and multiple logical interfaces would be treated as multiple carrier connections. It will be backward compatible and even devices with a single eSIM chip connected to a modem should be able to support MEP. It will be platform agnostic as well. That said, we will have to see how Google decides to license its patented tech. <https://dgit.in/googlemep>

Instagram update brings better messaging and music sharing features

Instagram is stepping up its game as a social networking app with a host of messaging features. You get to reply to Direct Messages while you are browsing the feed, and when you find something interesting, it can be shared with close friends quickly. If you don't want to disturb the other person with your messages, there's an option to deliver them quietly too. On



the contrary, when you want to suggest to the other person a new piece of music, you can send a 30-second preview of it from Spotify, Amazon Music, and Apple Music. Speaking of

music, you can personalise the chats with your dear ones using new LoFi wallpapers. Meta is working on blurring the distinction between the various social media platforms. Well, not just its apps like Instagram, Messenger, Whatsapp, etc, but is also known to take inspiration from competitors like TikTok, Snapchat, Telegram, etc. <https://dgit.in/instaupdate>



WhatsApp voice messages get six new features

WhatsApp just took to Twitter to announce new voice messages features. The new features include out of chat playback, pause and resume recording, preview voice message, waveform visualisation, fast playback, and more. <https://dgit.in/whatsappvoice>



YouTube Picture-in-Picture mode launched on iOS

YouTube iOS users are finally getting picture-in-picture (PiP) mode. However, the feature is limited to the YouTube TV app for now. Nevertheless, the feature is coming to all users, premium or otherwise in the regular YouTube app sometime soon. <https://dgit.in/ytpipios>



Sony PlayStation Plus announced with multiple tiers

Sony has rejigged its PlayStation subscription services with the all-new PlayStation Plus (PS+). PlayStation Plus has three membership plans namely, Essential, Extra, and Premium. The latter two bring more games to download and stream. <https://dgit.in/psplus>